MULTIPLAYER TEXT ADVENTURE

ONLINE · 1+ PLAYERS

THE ANSWER PROTOCOL

A SHARED-WORLD ADVENTURE



PLAYER'S MANUAL

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◆ BEFORE YOU PLAY

The Answer Protocol is played online: everyone connects to the same server and shares one world. Someone has to start it first:

- `make install` once
- `make run-server`
- `make run-client-gui` in another terminal

Prefer typing? See **Command line** on page 10.

WARNING

Sending commands too fast earns a **1-minute timeout**. Keep going during a timeout and the server bans you for 20 minutes.

GETTING STARTED

CHOOSE A NAME

The login window asks for a username of **2 to 10 characters**. Spaces aren't allowed, and a name someone online is already using is refused. Press CONNECT.

YOUR FIRST STEPS

Every adventurer begins in the **Taverne**. Look at what's around you, talk to the tavern keeper, and head out through the door to the east.

IF YOU FALL

Lose a fight and you wake up in the **Chapel** with half your HP. Nothing else is lost: your items, gold and quests stay with you.

YOUR ADVENTURER

HP **100**. Your health.

STR **7**. Strength, your base damage.

BSK **7**. Battle skill, extra damage on a lucky swing.

DEX **10**. Dexterity, your chance to dodge a blow.

Some quest rewards make you stronger.

YOUR STATUS

healthy, **weakened** (60% HP or less), **injured** (30% HP or less), or **engaged** while fighting.

HINT

Healing NPCs can bless you with light and mend all wounds.

THE GAME SCREEN



The Taverne, as seen on arrival. Details on the next page.

THE GAME SCREEN

1. **HP bar.** Your health right now.
2. **Room name.** Where you are.
3. 🌐 **Online.** Players on the server.
4. **STATUS.** Opens your status, gold and whether you're in a party.
5. `LOOK` / `BATTLE LOG`. Switch between the room details and the record of your fights.
6. **Room details.** Description, players, NPCs, exits and items.
7. 🏠 **Room.** Players in this room.
8. **D-pad.** Walk north, south, east, west, up or down. Only real exits light up.
9. **DROP list.** What you carry. Click an item to drop it.
10. **TAKE list.** Items lying in the room. Click one to pick it up.
11. **Chat and log.** Chat on the left, everything else on the right. Errors also flash up briefly above them.
12. **Command line.** Type any command yourself.
13. **Chat buttons.** `G` `R` `P` start a message, `C` clears it.
14. **GROUP.** Form a party (page 9).
15. **INTERACTIONS.** Talk, quest, attack and flee (pages 7–8).
16. **QUERIES.** Inventory, quests, key items and who's online, shown in the log.
17. 🖼️ **Show/Hide,** 🔍 **Examine,** 👋 **Quit.** Hide the panels to admire the view, take a closer look at something, or leave.

EXPLORING

MOVING AROUND

Use the d-pad to walk. Rooms connect in six directions: north, south, east, west, and sometimes **up** or **down**. Buttons for exits that don't exist stay dark.

LOOKING AROUND

The room details keep themselves up to date, so you'll see when someone walks in or picks something up. While the battle log is showing, LOOK switches back to them.

EXAMINING

🔍 starts an EXAMINE command for an NPC, an item or a key item. Finish it with a name, for example `EXAMINE ITEM old lute`, and the description appears in the log.

ITEMS

Some things can be picked up; others, like a fountain or an anvil, stay where they are. Every item exists **only once** in the world: if you pick it up, nobody else can until you drop it again.

KEY ITEMS 🔑

Key items are not ordinary items. You can't drop them, they never show up in rooms, and every player gets their own. They come from quests: a parcel to deliver, a reward to keep. Check yours with KEY ITEMS.

HINT

A 🔑 in someone's words means they've handed you a key item.

TOWNSFOLK & QUESTS

TALKING

TALK opens a list of everyone in the room. Pick a name and their words appear in the chat window. Talk again and they may say something new.

QUEST and ATTACK open the same kind of list.

HEALING

Talk to a healer while you're hurt and your HP is restored in full.

TAKING ON A QUEST

Some townsfolk need a hand. Press QUEST and choose them. If they have a task for you, you accept it on the spot.

- Follow what they tell you: find someone, go somewhere, or deal with a troublemaker.
- QUESTS lists your quests and how far along each one is.
- Stuck? Talk to whoever gave you the quest. They may drop a hint about where to go next.
- Rewards can be key items, gold, or both. Gold appears in your status panel.
- Finishing one quest can open up another.

STARTING A FIGHT

Not everyone in town is friendly. Press ATTACK and pick a foe. Fights are one-on-one: while a player fights someone, nobody else can challenge them.

EACH ROUND

- Press ATTACK again for every round.
- Both sides roll a die. The higher roll strikes first (you win a tie).
- Both sides exchange blows.
- The higher your dexterity, the better you will be able to dodge enemy attacks.

The **battle log** opens by itself and records every roll, hit and miss.



Something stirs in the dark...

HOW IT ENDS

- **Victory:** your foe is beaten, not killed. They'll be back, ready for the next challenger.
- **Defeat:** you wake in the Chapel with half your HP. Your quests are still waiting.
- FLEE lights up during a fight. Running away keeps your HP but earns nothing.

PLAYING TOGETHER

CHAT

Pick who should hear you, type your message and press Enter:

- `G` **Global:** everyone online.
- `R` **Room:** everyone in the same room.
- `P` **Party:** your group only. It lights up once you're in one.

WHO'S AROUND?

🌐 and 🏠 count the players online and in your room. `WHO` lists the names in your room.

TIP

`C` clears whatever you've typed in the command line.

FORMING A PARTY

- `CREATE` starts a party with you as its leader.
- `INVITE` lets a player know you'd like them to join. Type their name after it.
- `JOIN` followed by the **leader's** name puts you in their party.
- `LEAVE` takes you out again. If the leader leaves, the party breaks up.

While you're in a party, your status panel shows **In Party** ✔️.

HINT

Items are shared by the whole world. If you drop something, someone else may pick it up.

COMMAND LINE

The CLI clients (`make run-client` for Go, `make run-rust-client` for Rust) and the GUI's command line take the same commands. Capitals are optional, and names can be typed as they appear in the game.

EXPLORING

`LOOK`	Describe the room
`MOVE <direction>`	Walk through an exit
`TAKE <item>`	Pick up an item
`DROP <item>`	Put it down
`INVENTORY`	What you carry
`EXAMINE ITEM <item>`	Also `NPC`, `KEYITEM`

TOWNSFOLK

`TALK <npc>`	Speak to someone
`QUEST <npc>`	Accept their quest
`QUESTS`	Your quest progress
`KEYITEMS`	Your key items

COMBAT & YOU

`ATTACK <npc>`	Fight one round
`FLEE`	Run away
`STATUS`	HP and status
`GOLD`	Your gold

TOGETHER

`WHO`	Players here and online
`CHAT ROOM <message>`	Also `GLOBAL`, `GROUP`
`GROUP CREATE`	Also `INVITE <player>`, `JOIN <leader>`, `LEAVE`
`QUIT`	Leave (Ctrl+C or Ctrl+D also work)

TIPS FROM THE LOCALS

- Talk to everyone, and then talk to them again.
- When a quest seems stuck, go back to the person who gave it to you.
- Watch your HP between fights. The Chapel is never far away.
- Leaving the game ends your adventure. Progress doesn't carry over to your next visit, and anything you carry goes back where you found it.

ABOUT

The Answer Protocol was made as a project for the 42 curriculum: a Go server, CLI clients in Go and Rust, and a GUI client in Go with Fyne. The world, its people and their stories were written by speterse.

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